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UAE internet users hit by Red Sea cable cuts

DUBAI

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A series of undersea cable cuts in the Red Sea have significantly slowed down internet access across the Middle East and parts of Asia, including India and Pakistan. The disruption was also felt in the UAE, where users of internet providers du and e& reported slow speeds and intermittent access over the weekend. While service had largely improved by yesterday, some users continued to report issues.

The cause of the cable cuts has not been officially confirmed. Undersea fibre optic cables are the primary backbone of the global internet, and damage to them can be caused accidentally by ships dropping anchors. However, they can also be the target of deliberate attacks, which has raised concerns in the region.

Internet monitoring group NetBlocks pointed to 'failures affecting the SMW4 and IMEWE cable systems near Jeddah, Saudi Arabia' as the source of the disruption.

UAE GDP hits Dh455b in Q1 as non-oil share climbs to 77.3%

NON-OIL GDP RISES 5.3% YEAR-ON-YEAR TO DH352B TO REACH HISTORIC PEAK

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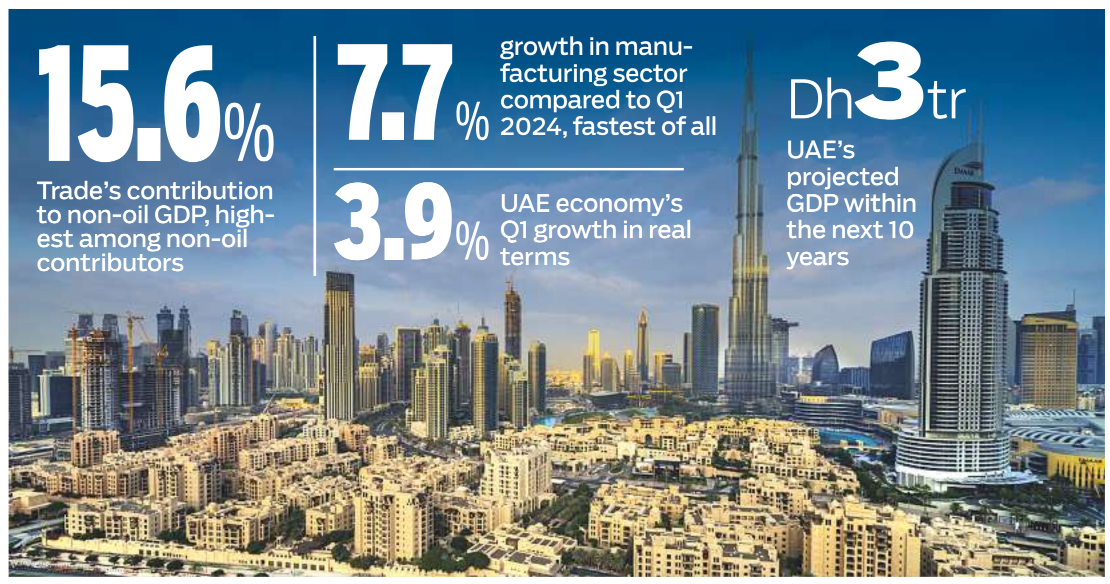

The UAE's economy grew 3.9 per cent in real terms during the first quarter of 2025, with gross domestic product valued at Dh455 billion, according to preliminary figures released by the Federal Competitiveness and Statistics Centre.

Non-oil GDP rose 5.3 per cent year-on-year to Dh352 billion, bringing its contribution to 77.3 per cent of total output, the highest level in the country's history. Oil-related activities accounted for 22.7 per cent of GDP during the same period.

Record share

Manufacturing was the fastest-growing sector in the first quarter, expanding 7.7 per cent compared to the same period in 2024. Finance and insurance, along with construction, each recorded 7 per cent growth, while real estate activities rose 6.6 per cent. Trade advanced by 3 per cent.

In terms of contribution to non-oil GDP, trade led with 15.6 per cent, followed by finance and insurance at 14.6 per cent, manufacturing at 13.4 per cent, construction at 12 per cent, and real estate at 7.4 per cent.

This growth is a testament for both resilience and steady momentum across non-oil sectors, which now account for a record share of national output.

Abdullah Bin Touq Al Marri, Minister of Economy and Tourism, said the first-quarter estimates reflects the strength and flexibility of the national economy and its ability to sustain exceptional growth.

Al Marri added that the results highlight the success of the UAE's comprehensive development model and reflect investor confidence in the business and investment environment, which he described as a global benchmark in adopting advanced policies and supportive regulatory frameworks.

"With the leadership's support, the contribution of non-oil activities to real GDP has reached a historic peak," Al Marri said. He attributed the achievement to the government's economic strategies aimed at building a knowledge- and innovation-based economy in line with the "We the UAE 2031" vision, which targets GDP of Dh3 trillion within the next decade.

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